

30 Minutes Expert Faster, Safer Windows XP

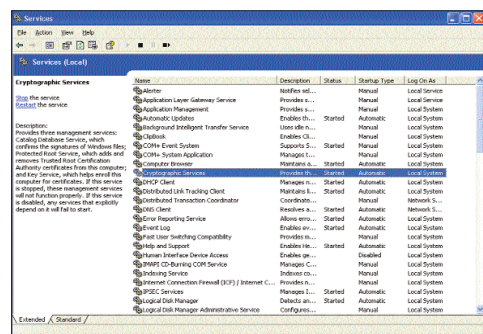
Windows XP is known for its beautiful new interface, coupled with the stability of Windows 2000. The only problem is, there are some chinks you may want to iron out. XP comes with a whole bunch of in-built applications that are really useful if you want to run a server or some database applications. The problem is that these applications all seem to start simultaneously, whether you need them or not, and use up precious system resources. The following is a guide to making XP work for

you, without killing your resources.

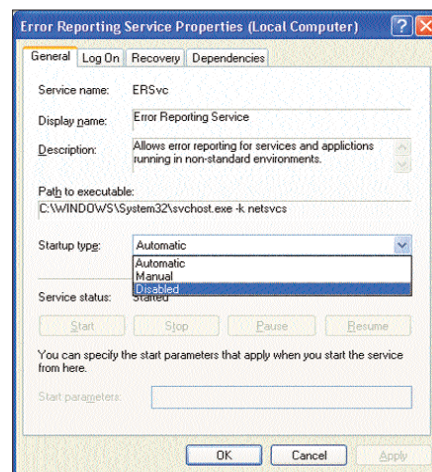
The most effective way to disable services is by running the Windows Management Interface. Access it through either **Control Panel > Administrative Tools > Services** or go to **Start > Run**, type `services.msc` and press **[Enter]**. A window pops up that displays all the services, their descriptions and status—whether currently running or not. From here you can start, stop, pause, resume, or restart a service.

In the table below, we have provided the configuration settings for three types of PCs—Safe, Internet Gateway and Gaming. Those who want the maximum out of their system for games, should set the services according to the Gaming Configuration. And PCs used as Servers or Internet Gateways should use the list specified in the Internet Gateways configuration. The Safe configuration, is for those paranoid about security.

To disable services from here, just right-click a service and choose properties. Now, go to the list box named



Services.msc lets you to tweak Windows XP



Disable services by right-clicking on them from the services.msc box

'startup type'. Select whichever of the three options (automatic, manual and disabled) is applicable.

Disabling most remote services will not only increase your PC speed, but also improve your security. For example, make sure to disable the Remote Registry Service, which basically allows your registry to be edited from a remote location—apart from the security risks, you're probably never going to want to edit your registry over the Internet anyway.

If you feel that you don't know whether you require this service or not just set it to 'manual' run. This way, Windows will not load it at startup, only when it is required. Finally, be careful about selecting from the services listed above, and remember to restart your PC after making the changes. You can now enjoy a faster and less resource hungry XP.

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Note

There may be services which may or may not be installed on your PC depending on whether it's Windows XP Home, or Windows XP Professional. Also, if it came pre-installed by your vendor, he may not have installed any or many of them. For more information visit www.blackviper.com

The following is a list of those services available in Windows XP:

Display Name	Safe	Internet Gateway	Gaming
Application Layer Gateway Service	Manual	Automatic	Disabled
Automatic Updates	Manual	Automatic	Disabled
Computer Browser	Disabled	Automatic	Disabled
Error Reporting Service	Disabled	Disabled	Disabled
Help and Support	Disabled	Disabled	Disabled
Indexing Service	Disabled	Disabled	Disabled
Logical Disk Manager	Manual	Manual	Disabled
Network Location Awareness (NLA)	Manual	Automatic	Disabled
Performance Logs and Alerts	Disabled	Disabled	Disabled
Portable Media Serial Number	Disabled	Disabled	Disabled
Remote Access Auto Connection Manager	Manual	Automatic	Disabled
Remote Access Connection Manager	Manual	Automatic	Disabled
Remote Desktop Help Session Manager	Disabled	Disabled	Disabled
Remote Procedure Call (RPC) Locator	Manual	Manual	Manual
Remote Registry Service	Disabled	Disabled	Disabled
Routing and Remote Access	Disabled	Disabled	Disabled
Server	Disabled	Automatic	Disabled
Smart Card	Disabled	Disabled	Disabled
System Restore Service	Disabled	Disabled	Disabled
Task Scheduler	Disabled	Disabled	Disabled
WMI Performance Adapter	Disabled	Disabled	Disabled